

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH  
*of Los Angeles*

*Turning Over Tables:  
A Lenten Call for Disrupting Power  
Palm Sunday*

*April 13th, 2025*



*Palm Sunday Art by Mark Jennings*

540 S. Commonwealth Avenue, Los Angeles, California 90020  
Telephone 213.385.1341 – [www.FCCLA.org](http://www.FCCLA.org)

## **The Gathering of the People**

*First Congregational Church of Los Angeles is a safe place for all people, and we celebrate our diversity of race, creed, age, ability, gender, religion, cultural background, sexual orientation, gender identities and expressions... We extend a warm welcome to all this morning and especially those who are with us for the first time. Your presence both enriches us and this time of celebration together ~*

### **Organ Prelude Concert**

**Dr. Christoph Bull, Organist-in- Residence**

Improvisation on ST. THEODULPH and ELLACOMBE  
Wachet auf, ruft uns die Stimme, BWV 645 (Johann Sebastian Bach)  
Air in D Major, BWV 1068 (Johann Sebastian Bach)  
A Whiter Shade Of Pale (Brooker / Fisher / Reid)  
Variations on B-A-C-H (Christoph Bull)

### **Chiming of the Hour**

#### **Welcome**

**Rev. Michael Lehman**

#### **Words of Gathering for Palm Sunday**

**Rev. Chad Tanaka Pack & Rev. Lehman**

*from the Gospel of Mark, Chapter 11*

*Please stand in body or in spirit for our Palm Sunday Processional*

#### **\*Palm Sunday Processional**

*All Glory Laud and Honor*

ST. THEODULPH

All glory, laud, and honor to you, O Christ, we sing,  
to whom the lips of children made sweet hosannas ring!  
The people of the Hebrews with palms adorned your way;  
our praise and prayer and anthems we offer you this day.

O Promised One of Israel, of David's royal line,  
the one called 'God's beloved,' of flesh and yet divine,  
to you, before your passion, they sang their hymns of praise;  
to you, now high exalted, our melody we raise.

As you received their praises, receive our prayers today,  
whose justice and whose mercy and sovereignty hold sway.  
All glory, laud, and honor to you, O Christ, we sing,  
to whom the lips of children made sweet hosannas ring!

#### **\*Prayer of Awareness**

**Rev. Laura Vail Fregin & Claire Kelly**

Eternal One,  
in stillness we open our hearts  
to the whispers of Holiness.

Chords of music  
fill us with deep reverence  
for the wonders we see and know in creation.

The rhythms of life come constant to us  
through the blessing of music  
and steady our pulse.

*Silence*

*On this Palm Sunday,  
let us overflow with the gifts of past and present  
and feel the sacred in each note,  
each chord,  
each melody of life.*

May it ever be so.  
*Amen and Amen.*

**\*Introit**

*"Gozos For St. Joseph"*

TRADITIONAL, arr. CRAIG H. RUSSELL

Cathedral Choir & players from Musica Angelica, Lorenzo Zapata, *Soloist*

**\*Palm Sunday Lord's Prayer**

**Rev. Lehman**

*God - heart of the world,  
revealed through every aspect of creation,  
understood through our awareness.*

*May we honor the holiness of creation and act accordingly  
so that your love is reflected in the way we live.  
May we always be thankful for the food we eat  
and the friends we have.  
May we forgive those who transgress against us  
and be forgiven for our own.*

*In the freedom of love may we live as your heartbeat  
and not be compromised by hesitation.  
Through our freedom, may your justice  
be seen and heard and experienced  
forever and ever.  
Amen and Amen!*

[Sherri J. Weinberg]

**\*Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,  
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.  
World without end, Amen, Amen.

**\*Passing of the Peace**

**Rev. Tanaka Pack**

We are invited this morning  
to open our hearts to the healing light  
of the Holy One's encircling presence.

*We are invited this morning  
to be aware of the gifts of this day.*

We ask that we will be surprised with small joys  
and pieces of beauty scattered through the hours.

*We ask that the beautiful presence  
of the Holy will help us this day,  
to taste the joy that peace  
with the divine life, and with each other,  
can bring.*

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.  
*And also with you!*

*You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow.*

**Please be seated**

**A Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition**  
*from the Gospel of Mark*

**Rev. Lehman**

This is the Gospel of Love and Grace.  
*Thanks be to God!*

**Homily**

**Rev. Fregin**

**Bach and the Mexican Baroque**

“Wachet Auf” from *Wachet Auf* BWV 140  
Cathedral Choir and players from Musica Angelica

J.S. BACH

“Gloria” from “Polychoral Mass in D”  
Cathedral Choir and players from Musica Angelica

IGNACIO DE JERUSALEM

“Gloria”

Laurel Irene, Anna Caplan, Michael Jones, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Soloists*

“Gratias agimus tibi”

Michael Jones, Laurel Irene, Christin Byrdsong, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Soloists*

“Qui tollis pecata mundi”

Katelyn Dietz, Christin Byrdson, David Conley, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Soloists*, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Assistant Conductor*

“Quoniam tu solus Sanctus”

Scott Graff, *Soloist*, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Assistant Conductor*

“Cum Sancto Spiritu” and “Amen”

Anna Caplan, Brandon Harris, Tiffany Ho, Andi Dana, *Soloists*, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Assistant Conductor*

“Celebren, publiquen, etonen y canten”

MANUEL DE SUMAYA

Laude and players from Musica Angelica, Anna Caplan, Frank Hobbs, & Lorenzo Zapata, *Soloists*

“Wachet Auf” (chorale)

J.S. BACH

Cathedral Choir and players from Musica Angelica

*We give thanks to supporters of the music program whose generosity makes mornings like this one possible.  
If you would like to become a supporter of special music programs at The Cathedral, please speak with Dr. Harris.*

## ***Bach and the Mexican Baroque Translations***

### **"Gozos for St. Joseph"**

We celebrate immortal light in honor of Mary's husband. Your soul has been united with the author Who created you. Being so loved by God, your wealth is immense. Such purity sings of holy grace.

### **"Wachet Auf"**

"Wake up!" the voice calls us from high in the tower, "wake up!" At the midnight hour they call us with a clear voice: where are you, wise bridesmaids? Get up, the bridegroom comes; Stand up, take your lamps! Make yourselves ready for the wedding, you must go to meet him!

### **"Gloria" from "Polychoral Mass In D"**

Glory to God in the highest, and on earth, peace to all people. We praise you, we bless you, we adore you, we glorify you, we give you thanks for the power that you imbue into us and the world. Holy God, Heaven of Heaven, God the Creator of all. Jesus Christ, born of the Creator, Lamb of God, Child and Holy God. You, who feels our suffering, have mercy on us, receive our prayer.

### **"Celebren, publiquen, entonen y canten"**

Celebrate and sing, celestial Amphions, with metrical airs the happiness, the glories, the joys, and the peace you have foretold. And as the angelic hosts raise her to happiness, to glory, to joy, to peace, each one reveres the hope of her desire, and bears her in her class as pure, as queen, as virgin, as mother.

The three high hierarchies in faithful, kind, and loving humility request the one who rises triumphantly. The seraphim claim that he must remain in their choir, because if it is up to them to love, loving is a sea of seas. Each cherub asserts his admirable fullness that this bird of grace fills. The sovereign Mercurys of the sky, brilliant messengers, exclaim that this dawn announced peace to the world.

### **"Wachet Auf" (chorale)**

May gloria be sung to you with the tongues of men and angels, with harps and with cymbals. The gates are made of twelve pearls, in your city we are companions of the angels on high around your home. No eye has ever perceived, no ear has ever heard such joy. Therefore we are joyful, hurray, hurray!; forever in sweet rejoicing.

### **Players from Musica Angelica**

Lot Demeyer, oboe, Sookhyun Lee, oboe, Pablo O'Connell, taille, Mishkar Nunez-Fredell, *violin*, Courtney Kuroda, *violin*, Dr. Ashley Salinas, viola, Dr. Alexis Hayes-Pilon, Denise Briese, *violone*

### **Cathedral Choir | \*Laude**

David Harris, Music Director, Christoph Bull, Organist  
Fahad Siadat and Ianthe Marini, *Assistant Directors*  
Steve Gregoropoulos, Rev. Michael Lehman,  
and Brandon Harris, *Percussion*

Miriam Adhanom\* | Jennifer Almiron | Marie Ash  
Ayur Barduev | Christin Byrdsong\* | Beth Braun  
Donald Brown | Martha Butler | Anna Caplan\*  
Annette Carden-Dale | Carol Crawford | Ruthie Condren  
David Conley\* | Andi Dana\* | Michele Delliquadri  
Katelyn Dietz\* | Chiany Dri | Scott Forman-Orr  
Sarah Fuhrmeister | Scott Graff\* | Steve Gregoropoulos  
Brandon Harris\* | Jeff Hindman | Tiffany Ho\*  
Frank Hobbs\* | Jill Hornkohl | Laurel Irene\*  
Menghe Jing | Phil Jones | Mike Jones\*  
Sharon Chohi Kim\* | David Saul Lee\* | Michel Von Loh  
Scott Lyness | Jim Maslowski | Amin Musavikhah  
Bonnie Mitchell | Katie Norman | Christopher Parsons  
Molly Pease\* | Jay Prewitt-Cruz | Rohan Ramanan\*  
Saginaw Rozzo | Meg Russett | Nandini Sadagopan  
T.J. Sclafani | Ilsa Setziol | Grace Sheldon-Williams  
Maggie Stillman | Michel von Loh | Joanna Wallfisch\*  
Jennifer Walls | Jerod Yates | Lorenzo Zapata\*

**Invitation to Generosity****Rev. Tanaka Pack**

*At First Church, we consider every pledge, tithe, offering and contribution a gift for the life of our community of faith. No matter how it's given, our gifts show gratitude. You are invited to visit our website at [fccla.org/give](http://fccla.org/give). Our hospitality team will also be available at the exits when the service ends with baskets to collect gifts.*

**Offertory**

Short Prelude in C Major  
Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

ASCRIBED TO J.S. BACH

**\*Lenten Doxology**

Praise God from whom all blessings flow.  
Praise God, all creatures here below.  
Praise God above ye heavenly hosts.  
Creator, Christ, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

**\*Prayer of Offering****Rev. Tanaka Pack**

Gracious and Loving God,  
on this day we pray  
that your Spirit might fill these gifts  
we have given, and will give.  
We also ask Holy One, that we might all  
be filled and become vessels of your love,  
your hope, your joy, and your justice in the world.  
Remind us, O God, in these days of Holy Week,  
that we belong to you and we belong to each other.  
We pray this in the name of One,  
who shows us the many paths that lead  
to your Divine Presence.  
*Amen and Amen.*

*Please be seated***Life at First Church****Rev. Lehman & Rev. Fregin****Palm Sunday Words of Blessing****Rev. Lehman & Rev. Fregin**

Let hope now be present in every corner of your life,  
in every room you enter, every street you walk.

Let peace be beside you, around you, within you,  
as you encounter the path of life before you.

Let joy fill your life as you seek, and find,  
the blessings of the small gifts this life brings.

Remember that in the best times it was love  
that brought you the joy you have known,  
and in the worst times it was love that sustained  
your hope against all odds, as the peace  
that passes all understanding held you close.

# HOLY WEEK

## AT THE CATHEDRAL

### **Today, April 13 | Palm Sunday Celebration & Concert**

Organ Prelude Concert | 10:30am followed by Bach and the Mexican Baroque Concert at 11am. After our Palm Sunday service, Musica Angelica will delight our ears with Bach's "St. Matthew Passion" at 3pm!

### **Tuesday, April 15 - Sunday, April 20**

Walk the stone labyrinth anytime during Holy Week in Mayflower Courtyard as a space of reflection, meditation, and prayer

### **Holy Thursday, April 17 | Soup & Bread Dinner + Service of Communion**

Drinks & Gathering | 5pm followed by Dinner & Communion | 5:30pm. Please RSVP to Obie at [omederos@fccla.org](mailto:omederos@fccla.org).

### **Good Friday, April 18 | Labyrinth Walk & Stations of the Cross | 5pm-9pm**

Walk both cloth labyrinth (Shatto Chapel) and stone labyrinth (Mayflower Courtyard) and ponder the meanings of Good Friday with a reimagined Stations of the Cross

### **Easter Sunday, April 20, 10:30am**

Join our Easter celebration with special Organ-Prelude Concert, Service, & Festival

*Visit our website at [www.fccla.org/calendar](http://www.fccla.org/calendar) for more info on all events & how to get your tickets!*

Rely on this love, draw deeply from its wells of strength,  
be filled with its possibilities.  
Even if you imagine it to be only a spark amid the shadows,  
its light will never leave you.

*Let love be present now, and in all the days to come,  
as we become the people who bring light to this life  
we are privileged to share.*

[The Right Rev. Stephen Charleston, Choctaw]

**\*Hymn for the Journey**

***Hosanna, Loud Hosanna***

ELLACOMBE

Hosanna, loud hosanna, the little children sang.  
Through pillared court and temple the lovely anthem rang:  
To Jesus, who had blessed them, close folded to his breast.  
The children sang their praises, the simplest and the best.

From Olivet they followed amid a cheering crowd,  
The victory palm branch waving, and chanting clear and loud.  
The God of earth and heaven rode on in lowly state,  
And glad to see the children, slowed down the donkey's gait.

"Hosanna in the highest!" That ancient song is ours.  
For Christ is our Redeemer, and sing with all our powers:  
"Hosanna, Christ, we praise you with heart and life and voice.  
Hosanna! In your presence forever we'll rejoice!"

***Please be seated for the Postlude***

**Postlude**

**Dr. Christoph Bull, Organist-in-Residence**

Variations on B-A-C-H - Reprise (Christoph Bull)

**Inside The Music**

"An ancient Central American myth tells of angels who realize that they couldn't directly give humans the tools to recognize life's promise. They considered hiding the knowledge in the stars, but realized we would one day reach the stars, and the depths of the ocean, but knew that we would one day reach the depths. Instead, they chose to hide our ability to know ourselves deep within us, where we were less likely to look. "Wake up!" These forceful words begin one of J.S. Bach's most memorable cantatas. The story of the bridesmaids who have fallen asleep and let their oil run low captures a moment of great anxiety. As they scurry around looking for more oil, Bach's music responds. The churning orchestral overdots announce the approaching event, the broken melodic patters reveal the bridesmaid's panic, and the altos, tenors, and basses reveal life's complexity as they leap and bend around the prophetic text. The sopranos, however, convey the message with calm and clarity. "Life is passing you by," they call to us. "This is the moment to respond, to awaken to possibility that lies deep within you." One of the reasons that Bach's music continues to speak to us comes from the essential human drama that he is able to communicate in his music. "Wachet Auf!" is high drama that illuminates humanity's promise as individuals and to one another. As we celebrate the meaning that Bach's music has allowed us to find over the centuries, we also seek to uncover newness in the less-heard voices of Mexico's Baroque composers. Manuel de Sumaya, indigenous to Mexico and Bach's exact contemporary, became one of the most renowned composers of the Baroque era. His music is lively, broad, and layered. His output has been compared to that of Handel and Bach. He led music at the main cathedral in Mexico City in

addition to writing secular works for the stage and instrumental pieces. His villancico “Celebren, publiquen, entonen y canten” celebrates a moment of wakefulness. He references Greek mythology as he loosely references the Christmas birth. Mixing mythological characters in this way appears across much of the Americas, as indigenous artists began to include European stories into their own. In “Celebren”, various gods attend to the newborn hope for happiness, joy, and peace as the singers encourage them to celebrate in song and word. As with the Christmas story, Sumaya defines these attributes as the promise of awakening to our selves within the divine glow. The “Gloria” setting from Ignacio de Jerusalem’s “Polychoral Mass in D” also represents a “wake up!” moment. As sleepy shepherds waited out the night, the heavens opened up and Angelic voices told them to share messages of peace and joy with the world. The “Polychoral Mass in D” is a multi movement work reminiscent of Vivaldi and Bach’s choral works of the time. Jerusalem was born in Spain, and followed Sumaya at the cathedral in Mexico City. He was well known for his stage works and sacred music when he arrived in Mexico. His career was a dazzling one, most of which took place in the Americas. The two choirs of his “Polychoral Mass” pass ideas back and forth over the six-movement piece. Each movement’s brevity means that the dramatic elements occur rapidly in quick flashes. We can liken their presence to that of a flash of inspiration. Blink, and you may find it has gone. The Baroque music of the Americas has much in common with European composers. Yet, they have surprising and delightful differences. The rhythms of the Americas are different, the stories are told with an ear toward the earth (e.g. “loving is the sea of seas”) and community that would have surprised Europeans of the time. To welcome their sounds into our lives is to awaken to a world we only think we understand. As they begin to work their magic on us, we stir in new ways. This is why I delight in hearing music that I don’t know. This program encourages us in today’s world to recognize that wakefulness can be a life practice. We can learn to lead with curiosity and compassion such that we seek out new voices with an ear toward discovery. We can learn to listen with ears determined to invite difference into our day. Surely this openness to possibility coursed through the Palm Sunday crowds as Jesus entered. They were celebrating the chance that this individual might change their fortunes, or lighten the burden they carried because of a corrupt government. I wonder how many of them realized that the burden they carried, and the salve that he promised, started from within. How many of them had the opportunity within themselves to awaken in that powerful moment of release?” -Dr. David Harris

### **Translations**

#### **“Gozos for St. Joseph”**

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Who created you. Being so loved by God, your wealth is immense. Such purity sings of holy grace.

#### **“Wachet Auf”**

“Wake up!” the voice calls us from high in the tower, “wake up!” At the midnight hour they call us with  
a clear voice: where are you, wise bridesmaids? Get up, the bridegroom comes; Stand up, take your  
lamps! Make yourselves ready for the wedding, you must go to meet him!

#### **“Gloria” from “Polychoral Mass In D”**

Glory to God in the highest, and on earth, peace to all people. We praise you, we bless you, we adore  
you, we glorify you, we give you thanks for the power that you imbue into us and the world. Holy  
God, Heaven of Heaven, God the Creator of all. Jesus Christ, born of the Creator, Lamb of God, Child  
and Holy God. You, who feels our suffering, have mercy on us, receive our prayer.

“Celebren, publiquen, entonen y canten”

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“Wachet Auf” (chorale)

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Cathedral Choir | \*Laude

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